

iQOO 15's everyday promise

How the smartphone is built to meet daily needs according to CEO Nipun Marya

Aman Rashid | editor@digit.in

The iQOO 15 has officially launched in India, and it is easily one of the brand's most ambitious upgrades yet. You get the new Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 chipset, a sharper 2K OLED display, 40W wireless charging, a 50MP periscope camera and a bunch of small refinements that make it feel like a proper step forward from the iQOO 13. But the launch also comes at a time when smartphone components are getting costlier, and flagship prices across the industry are slowly rising. To understand how iQOO is approaching this new reality, what the iQOO 15 means for the brand, and where things are headed next, I sat down with Nipun Marya, CEO of iQOO India, for a quick conversation right after the launch. Here are the excerpts from the conversation.

Q The iQOO 15 arrives at a time when the cost of components has increased significantly. We're already seeing flagship prices inch upward across the industry. How has this impacted your pricing strategy for the iQOO 15? And more importantly, will this eventu-

ally trickle down to the mid-range and performance-focused models where iQOO has a strong foothold?

A Nipun: So, for the iQOO 15, when it comes to pricing, what we were more focused on was the upgrades we are offering over the iQOO 13.



Nipun Marya
CEO of iQOO India

From 13 to 15, there is an upgrade in the chipset, with the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5, the latest one. We have the Supercomputing Chip Q3 on the display, significant improvements with the 2K M14 Samsung display, which is the most advanced display a smartphone can have today.

Then we have wireless charging, which was missing from the iQOO 13, and the periscope camera, which was also missing. Overall, the package has become much stronger. When we were pricing the product, we had to keep these upgrades in mind, along with the supply chain prices, which have suddenly become very high. Still, I believe that at Rs 64,999, the price at which people will be able to get the iQOO 15 in the first few days, the price is phenomenal for the value it offers.

Q And what about the mid-range phones? Since component prices

are rising, will this pricing trend also trickle down to your mid-range and affordable models?

A Nipun: The way we are seeing the industry right now, I think it will. How much and which models, and until what price segments, time will tell. But certainly, the news in the industry and in the supply chain ecosystem is that prices are going to be affected across all model ranges and sectors.

Q Every iQOO number series has pushed performance, but this year, users are expecting a more visible leap. Beyond the raw chipset upgrade, what are the real-world improvements users will notice immediately, especially in scenarios where last year's iQOO 13 already performed extremely well?

A Nipun: You're absolutely right. The iQOO 13 was really loved by everyone who used it. With the iQOO 15, no stone has been left unturned when it comes to taking the flagship game to the next level. You talk about display, camera, battery, a 7000mAh silicon-carbon battery, completely new technology, then wireless charging. In every aspect you touch upon, and these are all real-life use cases, you will see significant improvement. For example, the periscope 3x lens was missing last time, but is now present. Your portraits are going to be much better because we've added a new 85mm focal length. For people who work in IT or other white-collar jobs, we have introduced Origin OS 6, which packs in a whole lot of features. My favourite is the Office Kit because I can mirror my phone to my PC or Mac and use it seamlessly. One Tap Transfer also helps a lot. Overall, in any aspect that you use the iQOO 15, you will be pleasantly surprised. **[d]**

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